

https://kehilalinks.jewishgen.org/nesvizh/nesvizh_home.html

My father, Isrol Leibovich Mostkov (Mostkoff), was born in 1880 in the shtetl of Ostrov, and died in Mexico in 1956. Both are buried in the Jewish cemetery in Mexico City.

<https://sztetl.org.pl/en/towns/o/1211-ostroh/99-history/137807-history-of-community>

MOSTKOW / [MOSTK], Samuel	born in 1883	singl e	- -	Piwna st. 2-33	Internal Passport Application	His mother's name was Khaya Sara GRODZIENSKA /[GRODZENSKY]. The German Passport #35539 issued in Vilnius 19-Feb-1916 is in the file.
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In Slutsk lived my father with his family (he had returned from Mississippi around 1905-8), his sister Lyubka — mother of Bronya and Grisha, from Leningrad — and, at a summer place in Urechye near Slutsk, another sister, Etl — mother of Musya and Anya Reznik. Our elderly grandmother Khaya lived with us for several years, and I remember her little chest full of colored balls of yarn — she was always knitting. I don't even remember when she left us, or perhaps died. I don't recall. We loved our Aunt Etl of Urechye very much. For us children, it was a joy to go to Urechye in the summer. Uncle Samuil Reznik worked at the railway station in Urechye, in charge of fuel supplies, and lived in a big official wooden house

This grandmother was the mother of my father, Isrol Mostkov. She lived her whole life in a distant village near the Polish border, near Nesvizh. I don't even remember her voice, so powerless and silent was she. This woman gave birth to and raised — or they raised themselves — many children. I knew her youngest son, my father, who was born in 1880; I heard about the eldest daughter Tayba, the son Motle, the daughter Ginde, the youngest son Eizer, and others. Their house stood by a bridge, and so, according to family legend, the surname Mostkov ("bridge") came about. What her husband, my grandfather Leiba, did for a living, I don't know, and there's no one left to ask. He was a poor man — that much I know for certain, and the growing young people left for America.

This was around the end of the last century. The elder brothers left, and with them my future father, then 15 years old. They ended up in Mississippi, and struggled, doing small trade and odd crafts, while the uncles worked for some employer.

What do I remember? I wake up at night and hear my mother crying. I went out barefoot into the hall, and there by the hot Dutch stove stood Papa, Mama, and Papa's nephew — already a young man of 17 or 18, Israel Tsukovich, son of the eldest sister.

Dysentery. A girl named Dveyra-Dora came to stay with us, my father's niece. My mother was very, very kind and felt for everyone. Some misfortune had struck their house — perhaps she was left an orphan — and she was brought to us. She was pretty and well-built, and I was 10, and we nibbled little apples the size of walnuts — just set, unripe — of which there were plenty, since the orchards around were ownerless after the fire. I remember only that I was sent to the pharmacy for medicine, and I was too shy to open the door — I sat outside and didn't dare knock and open the pharmacy door, because my uncle worked there as a pharmacist (a cousin of my mother's, Khaim Yudi). So I just sat there. Then I ran home and lied that I had been, that there was no medicine, but I was told — it's not needed anymore! At first I didn't understand and was even glad that it wasn't needed. Then, looking at my mother's grim face, I understood. Dveyra was already lying dead in the bedroom. She had died of dysentery. I remember my mother tearing at her own hair — she was pregnant at the time too. We children were strictly forbidden to pick or eat the little apples. In August 1921 my mother gave birth to a daughter and named her Dveyra (Dora).